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I. Pearl 2.0 MVP Brief

A. Background

How did we get here in a nutshell?

Pearl stands at a critical inflection point as we venture into new markets in pursuit of new opportunities with new market segments. Now more than ever, we need to ensure our new corporate purpose is aligned with our product innovation. The corporate Vision, Mission, and Goal create an urgent imperative for strategic product development that transforms how Americans engage with home performance.

1. The Strategic Foundation

a) Vision

(1) A world where ordinary people power energy transformation.

(a) This vision recognizes that lasting energy transformation cannot happen without grassroots adoption by everyday homeowners. Government initiatives and corporate mandates alone cannot achieve the scale needed for meaningful climate impact—it requires millions of ordinary Americans to prioritize energy efficiency in their homes.

b) Mission

(1) Make home performance matter.

(a) Currently, home value is determined by location, size, and aesthetics while ignoring the home's fundamental purpose: safeguarding comfort, well-being, and finances. Most American homes underperform because home performance remains invisible, unquantified, and undervalued. Our mission targets this market failure by making performance visible and valuable.

c) Goal

(1) Every home listing in America will include Pearl SCORE™ by the end of the decade.

(a) We've talked a lot about getting onto one of the big ILS portals—but that's just a means to an end. What we're really aiming for is to be part of every real estate transaction in America. This is bigger than platform integration; it's about becoming embedded in the fabric of how homes are bought and sold.

(b) The day Pearl SCORE™ is considered as essential a data point as square footage or number of bathrooms, we'll know we've reached that goal.

(c) This measurable milestone drives market transformation by institutionalizing home performance as a standard real estate consideration—fundamentally changing how homes are valued and driving decision-making at both the consumer and business level.

d) **Objectives**

(1) Complete Product Development

(2) Successfully pilot the Program on a major ILS

(3) Scale Nationally

2. The Product Imperative

a) Our VMG creates a clear product development mandate: develop products that make home performance visible, valuable, and actionable for ordinary people throughout their homeownership journey.

b) This requirement emerges directly from the strategic chain:

(1) Vision demands scale: To enable ordinary people to power energy transformation, we need tools that work at a massive scale across diverse homeowner segments

(2) Mission demands visibility: To make home performance matter, we must create products that translate complex building science into clear, actionable insights and compel people to use it (the "forcing factor").

(3) Goal demands market integration: To achieve ubiquitous Pearl Score adoption, our products must seamlessly integrate with existing real estate infrastructure.

3. The Market Reality

a) The housing market currently fails both homebuyers and homeowners because performance remains disconnected from value. Homeowners lack the tools to understand, improve, or leverage their home's performance. Buyers and real estate professionals have no standardized way to see or communicate performance value. This disconnect perpetuates a cycle where performance improvements are overlooked and undervalued.

b) Our product development must break this cycle by creating an ecosystem where:

(1) Homebuyers can see, understand, evaluate, and compare home performance, creating demand for this information in real estate transactions.

(2) Homeowners can discover their home's performance baseline and improvement opportunities.

(3) Performance improvements translate into measurable, marketable value

(4) Real estate transactions incorporate performance as a standard consideration

(5) Market forces incentivize continued performance improvements

4. The Strategic Opportunity

a) Pearl's positioning as a purpose-built solution for ILS portals creates unprecedented scale opportunities. The portals represent the only viable path to reach millions of consumers cost-effectively while building instant credibility and authority. This distribution strategy aligns perfectly with our VMG:

(1) Vision alignment: Portal integration reaches ordinary people at the moment they're making critical housing decisions

(2) Mission alignment: ILS placement makes home performance visible and relevant during property searches

(3) Goal alignment: Portal adoption accelerates the path to universal Pearl Score inclusion in listings

5. The Product Development Challenge

a) Our VMG requires products that serve multiple, interconnected purposes, including but not limited to:

(1) For Home Buyers: Fill in the performance blind spot that exists in real estate listings today and transform complex home performance data into actionable insights that help the buyer choose the best home for their priorities.

(2) For Homeowners: Transform complex home performance data into actionable insights that connect personal benefits (comfort, savings, health) to performance upgrades (not to mention broader environmental impact).

(3) For Real Estate Professionals: Provide trusted, standardized performance metrics that enhance property differentiation, transaction speed, and value.

(4) For ILS Partners: Increase listing engagement, buyer confidence, and lead conversion by embedding credible third-party insights that extend time-on-site and differentiate their platform.

(5) For Contractors: Generate higher-quality leads and provide a trusted pathway for customers to understand, plan, and act on home improvement opportunities.

(6) For Lending Professionals: Create the infrastructure and data insights that make performance-based home underwriting possible and profitable.

(7) For Appraisers: Provide credible, simple tools that enable home performance to be considered in every home appraisal.

(8) For Pearl: Establish a user base and build sustainable revenue streams while advancing the mission of market transformation.

6. The Urgency Factor

a) Climate change demands a rapid transformation of residential energy and water consumption. Home energy and water use are an important part of that transformation. There are many ways to affect home energy and water use, but Pearl's chosen tactic is to engage consumers to make home performance matter. Although we do not include energy transformation or other environmental issues in our company or product profiling, it is the reason we do all this, and making performance matter is the precursor we need to trigger that transformation to a more habitable planet.

b) Our goal to achieve Pearl SCORE inclusion in every home listing "by the end of the decade" creates an urgent timeline for making home performance matter. This ambitious deadline requires product development that prioritizes user experience and scalable solutions, with the understanding that iteration at scale will drive improvement faster than extended development cycles, as long as:

(1) We start iterating from the right place with our MVP

(2) We have absolute clarity on where we are going and what our priorities are.

c) This brief is intended to support both these ambitions

d) The product we build must enable Pearl to move from niche certifier to national standard—the natural evolution required to fulfill our corporate vision and address the climate imperative that drives our existence.

B. Project Overview

Briefly describe the purpose of the exercise. Specifically address: a) who the instigator is, b) their need and motivation for this project, and c) what you want done succinctly.

1. Instigator

a) Executive leadership (Cynthia, Robin, Sandy) recognizes that Pearl's mission to make home performance matter requires a fundamental shift from contractor-focused certification to consumer-centric platform engagement.

2. Core Need

a) Develop Pearl MVP 2.0 that creates immediate, tangible value for homebuyers.

(1) This is the critical first step in transforming our contractor-centric model into a consumer-facing platform that will eventually serve the entire homeowner lifecycle.

3. What We Want Done

a) Build the foundational buyer-focused product that accomplishes three mission-critical objectives:

(1) Entice a major ILS Portal to partner with us:

(a) Deliver sufficient ILS value in addition to buyer value that major listing platforms see Pearl SCORE™ as essential listing content

(2) Convert ILS visitors to app users

(a) Find natural ways to convert ILS traffic, specifically, compel buyers to register on the app (desktop or mobile)

(3) Create Market Demand:

(a) On the product level, demand is generated by the degree to which the product is perceived as solving issues that matter to buyers better than other solutions they know about.

4. Expected Outcome

a) Pearl SCORE™ follow-through

(1) The Registry Release:

(a) Pearl SCORE™, Registry, and the Snapshot are scheduled to be released on their own in July 2025. These are significant milestones because these elements form the foundation upon which our debut MVP 2.0 consumer product will be built.

(i) These features are not our consumer product. Our MVP 2.0 consumer product has five parts that work seamlessly together to create value.

(a) Snapshot

(b) SCORE Report

(c) Pearl App (focused on home buyer and owner needs)

(d) Pearl PRO App (focused on the needs of consumer enablers)

(e) Portrait (Potential feature)

(i) A richer version of the Snapshot is available in the site/app environment. Another layer of context provided to the snapshot info that we have given the working title of "Portrait" (meaning like a snapshot but a bit more refined). This keeps the snapshot streamlined and gives users who need it more info.

(ii) The MVP 2.0 launch will be a much more public affair in which we actively encourage home buyers to explore the value Pearl offers them.

(2) The MVP 2.0 Launch

(a) Pearl will most likely launch its new Pearl SCORE™ metric to the public in coordination with its inclusion in an ILS, most likely on a regional basis. This remains a wildcard in our planning since we don't know how we will launch or what requirements a launch partner may have.

(i) Ideally, we would debut the MVP 2.0 product on a major ILS.

(ii) If not, inclusion in one or more brokerage listing sites would be the next best option. Either of these solutions would give us the right context, the right type of traffic (buyers), and the most relevant validation to scale to more ILS portals.

(iii) We could also launch as a stand-alone product and drive traffic through our consumer enabler segments and some advertising. This could provide some traction and revenue, but would likely not produce the consumer validation that ILS portals and investors seek.

(b) When the launch happens, Pearl needs to emphasize that we offer more than an abstract score. We also need to demonstrate the score's practical application and provide the tools necessary for consumers to realize that value.

(3) Those tools will be developed and serve as the foundation for the four main consumer product releases as we work our way through the homeownership cycle:

(a) V2.0 SCORE Report - helps buyers understand performance and choose between homes.

(b) V2.1 Home Profile Dashboard - helps owners understand performance and gain agency over it and their SCORE. (a.k.a. Home Performance Hub)

(c) V2.2 Home Improvement Plan - helps owners prioritize improvements based on their priorities, including cost, the five pillars, and impact on value/ROI.

(d) V2.3 Home Listing Package - helps home sellers differentiate the home and highlight performance features for faster sales at their asking price.

(4) Packaging features and releases

(a) We may want to consider renaming some of these components.

(b) The packaging of the different components will be done as part of a broader Brand Architecture and Naming Conventions (BANC) exercise once we have a clearer picture of product features.

b) Clear intent

(1) Pearl MVP 2.0 will be the company's first step in our journey to become America's home performance authority. With its launch, we want to send a clear signal to the industry of Pearl's trajectory and intent.

(2) We need Pearl MVP 2.0 to establish Pearl as the go-to resource for performance-informed home buying decisions, creating the market foundation required for subsequent product phases that will expand across the full homeowner journey, and ultimately achieve our Goal of universal Pearl SCORE adoption.

5. Development Approach

a) This MVP represents Phase 1 of a strategic multi-release roadmap designed to systematically capture value across the entire homeowner lifecycle with subsequent releases..

C. How it is Today

Define the situation as it is today — specifically, the problem you are trying to solve. Attach a SWOT or other analytical tool if you feel it will help clarify the situation.

1. Pearl's Market Leadership Position

a) Our journey began by developing a product for high-performance homeowners and their contractors, designed to enable homeowners to capture the value of high-performing homes and home features. Along the way, we built one of the most comprehensive home performance platforms in the world, formed strong relationships with over 200 contractor partners, and sparked growing awareness among real estate professionals and other consumer enablers like lenders, insurers, and OEMs. This foundation now positions us to scale and meet the broader consumer opportunity ahead.

2. Competitive Advantage: First-Mover Status

a) Pearl currently enjoys a "soft monopoly" in comprehensive home performance certification. While partial solutions exist (ENERGY STAR for new construction, HERS ratings for energy only, with relevance primarily in the new construction space), no competitor offers Pearl's holistic approach covering safety, comfort, operations, resilience, and energy across existing homes. This head start provides crucial advantages:

(1) Established Data Infrastructure: With details on 87 million homes, the Pearl Registry is one of the nation's most comprehensive databases of home performance. As more home data is collected, the system grows smarter and more valuable— enhancing the accuracy

of scores, the relevance of insights, and the strength of Pearl's data-driven products. This also creates a competitive moat that grows wider with each claimed home.

(2) Proven Certification Methodology: Pearl SCORE™ represents years of refinement in translating complex building science into actionable consumer insights across five critical performance pillars.

(3) Industry Credibility: Partnerships with the National Association of Realtors, the Appraisal Institute, major manufacturers, the US Department of Energy, and various industry organizations establish Pearl as the trusted home performance authority among professionals.

(4) Policy Alignment: The Inflation Reduction Act and state energy programs create unprecedented demand for third-party certification, positioning Pearl as the obvious solution partner.

3. ILS Portal Interest: The Timing Advantage

a) Major listing platforms actively seek differentiated content to enhance their value propositions and user engagement. Recent conversations indicate strong ILS interest in performance data integration, representing a massive distribution opportunity that could reach millions of home buyers simultaneously.

4. Market Tailwinds: Perfect timing convergence of several favorable conditions:

a) First-time homebuyers are surging—and they need help. The median age of first-time buyers is now 38, and many stretch their budgets to purchase older homes with unknown operating costs. This increases demand for clarity on performance, risk, and cost of ownership.

b) With significantly more sellers than buyers in the current market, the U.S. has entered a temporary buyer's market. In this environment, home buyers have more leverage to shape the buying process. Sellers and listing agents eager to sell swiftly at their asking price are more willing to accommodate buyer demands. However, given the persistent imbalance between the number of existing homes and the number of households seeking them, this market dynamic is unlikely to last beyond the period of elevated interest rates.

c) Buyers view homes as financial assets, not just places to live. With home equity making up the majority of net wealth for many households, buyers are more motivated than ever to understand and protect their investment. Performance insights serve this need directly.

d) Real estate pros are under pressure to differentiate. Rising inventory and commission crackdowns are making it harder for agents and brokers to stand out. The recent NAR settlement requires buyer's agents to demonstrate their value in ways not previously necessary. Tools that add value to listings—like a verified performance score—are gaining appeal.

e) Portals are searching for new user value. ILS sites are competing fiercely for traffic, relevance—and revenue. As lower inventory levels and shrinking buyer commissions cut into traditional income streams, embedding trusted, third-party insights into listings offers a proven way to engage users, extend time-on-site, and open new monetization paths.

f) Consumer expectations for data have never been higher. In a world where every decision is backed by reviews, ratings, and scores, today's buyers expect transparent, trusted information—especially for high-stakes purchases like homes. Pearl SCORE™ is arriving just in time.

g) Rising energy costs are increasing consumer interest in performance features at the same time that technology infrastructure is making energy management easier for consumers and enabling seamless data integration across platforms.

h) Climate-related disasters are rapidly re-shaping insurance markets. Homeowners will find insurance significantly more expensive, or even impossible to obtain. Insurance companies will be under pressure to incentivize homeowners to make resilience improvements to their homes.

5. Current Assets and Capabilities

a) Technology Platform: Robust certification system capable of scaling to millions of homes with established API infrastructure for partner integrations.

b) Brand Recognition: Among industry professionals, Pearl is recognized as the premium home performance authority with strong credibility and trust.

c) Strategic Partnerships: Existing relationships with manufacturers, utilities, and government entities provide multiple pathways for consumer education and demand generation.

d) Product Portfolio: Comprehensive suite of tools (Pearl app, certification system, contractor platform) ready for consumer-facing evolution.

6. The Buyer Opportunity Gap

a) The enormous opportunity lies in the complete absence of performance information during home buying—the critical moment when buyers make their largest financial decisions. This represents a massive white space opportunity:

b) Today's millions of buyers search platforms daily for property insights, yet listing sites lack any standardized home performance information. Real estate agents, lenders, and insurers also lack this critical information. At the same time, the real estate industry is open to new tools that help agents, so long as they're simple, free, and don't add extra work. No established competitor currently delivers performance data to this consumer market at such scale and ease.

(1) We're tracking a near-term dip to ~4 million home transactions again in 2025 due to elevated mortgage rates and market uncertainty. However, the long-term average remains ~5 million per year. For strategic forecasting, we use 5 million as the foundational annual market size—recognizing that swings below (or above) this level reflect market cycles, not enduring structural shifts.

7. The Strategic Moment

a) Pearl's decade of industry-focused development has created the perfect foundation for consumer market entry. We possess the credibility, data, technology, and partnerships necessary to become the definitive consumer platform for home performance—if we act decisively to capture this unprecedented opportunity.

b) The combination of our first-mover advantage, established infrastructure, favorable market conditions, and ILS portal interest creates a rare strategic moment where the right product launch could establish Pearl as the dominant platform in a category we pioneered.

D. Who are We Talking To?

Describe the target market for this communication as an individual.

1. The Broad Market

a) While Pearl's long-term opportunity spans multiple verticals—from real estate and remodeling to finance and public policy—success starts with disciplined focus. Today's market landscape consists of three core segment types:

(1) Consumers

(2) Consumer Enablers

(3) Data Buyers

b) Of these, consumers are the linchpin—their engagement creates the demand that powers the entire ecosystem.

c) We have further segmented consumers into four main segments: Home buyers, homeowners, home improvers, and home sellers. It's important to understand that Pearl's target segmentation framework is not a set of fixed, mutually exclusive categories. These segments are modeled around needs, not permanent identities. Homeowners and buyers may flow through multiple segments over time—or even straddle more than one at a given moment.

d) These categories are designed to be dynamic waypoints in a lifecycle—not silos. Their purpose is to help us identify core needs at each phase and tailor our engagement strategies accordingly.

e) To unlock the full value of this consumer ecosystem, home buyers are the logical starting point for MVP 2.0. This is not a dismissal of other segments—it's a sequencing decision rooted in traction, cost efficiency, and ecosystem design.

2. Five Reasons To Start With Home Buyers

a) Home Buyers Are the Entry Point Into the Homeownership Lifecycle

(1) Every homeowner was first a buyer. Engaging them at this stage gives us the opportunity to shape their understanding of home performance from the beginning—especially if we can win them over as first-time buyers.

b) They Are Highly Motivated and Information-Seeking

(1) Buyers are in active decision-making mode. They crave clarity on costs, risks, and value. Pearl provides all three.

c) Customer Acquisition Costs Should Be Lowest at This Stage

(1) The willingness to pay for decision support (via a SCORE Report, for instance) makes this a uniquely promising point of entry. In fact, nearly 90% of buyers already spend

$500–$700 on a home inspection, demonstrating a strong precedent for paying out of pocket for trusted, third-party insights during the purchase process.

d) **Home Buyers Have the Most Potential To Convert Into Higher-Value Lifecycle Customers**

(1) By engaging them at the start of their homeownership cycle, we will remain at their side as they become owners who claim their home, improvers who subscribe, and sellers who market their performance. This sequential value pays the greatest dividend when we engage newbie buyers.

e) **Home Buyer Behavior Pressures Upstream Segments**

(1) When buyers expect performance data, sellers, agents, and others adapt to provide it, forcing alignment across the ecosystem.

3. **Home Buyer Segmentation**

a) **Passives**

(1) Buyers without specific performance orientation but open to better information

(2) These people do not reject the importance of performance; it's just not on their radar. We need to get on their radar.

b) **Newbies**

(1) First-time homebuyers, often overwhelmed, seeking confidence and clarity

(2) They are usually buying at the top of their affordability spectrum and usually buying older homes with deferred maintenance. Know very little about home systems. Their needs are very much in line with Pearl's offer.

c) **Seekers**

(1) Actively looking for high-performing features.

(2) (Perhaps they are environmentally oriented, have allergies, want lower utility bills, or perhaps they covet their neighbor's solar panels. While a brand new home may come with more high-performance features, it may not be in their budget, so they are looking for used homes that perform in one or several dimensions.

d) **Newbie Seekers**

(1) First-timers with performance priorities

(2) These should be our easiest segment to convert to loyal Pearl App users.

4. **Passive Targets**

a) Our promotion may be speaking to home buyers, but we need to be aware of who else is in the room listening and how they might serve our needs. As anyone who studies the traffic on major ILS portals knows, active buyers only account for a fraction of daily visitors.

b) **Window shoppers**

(1) Millions of visitors a day scan the listings with no intention of buying (estimated to account for 60% of Zillow's traffic).

(2) They have different reasons for their browsing. For many its entertainment value - real estate browsing has become a form of "lifestyle porn" similar to browsing luxury goods. For others, it's aspirational dreaming, future planning and goal-setting, curiosity about local market conditions and property values, or just a more pleasant option than doomscrolling. Many activate push notifications during their home search that they never shut off.

(3) What they have in common is that they are all high engagement, low conversion: They spend time scrolling, saving, sharing—without taking transactional steps. In that crowd are millions of current or future homeowners.

(4) This audience is not noise—they're pre-funnel leads. The challenge is how to turn curiosity into commitment through education, planning tools, affordability modeling, and emotion-to-action journeys.

(5) While our product development or GTM strategy need not cater to these individuals, we should be aware that they comprise a large share of the traffic on ILS portals today.

5. Further Reading

a) Please See

(1) Appendix 2: Target Market and Positioning

E. Objective

What do you need to accomplish with this project?

Pearl MVP 2.0 must serve as our market entry vehicle into the consumer space, centered around the SCORE Report – an objective, comprehensive report that explains a home's performance across safety, comfort, operations, resilience, and energy. This release represents our strategic pivot from contractor-centric to consumer-centric engagement while establishing the foundation for achieving our corporate Goal of Pearl Score inclusion in every home listing by decade's end.

1. Primary Objective: The SCORE Report as Market Catalyst

a) Core Product Success

(1) The SCORE Report must become the definitive tool that buyers use to understand and compare home performance during their property search. Success means buyers recognize the SCORE Report as essential information for making informed housing decisions, creating measurable demand for this analysis across the real estate market.

b) Dual Revenue and Registration Strategy

(1) Execute a sophisticated conversion strategy that generates revenue through SCORE Report purchases while maximizing user registrations for platform engagement. We must achieve this without creating the trust-eroding perception of Pearl as a sales-centric, pushy brand. The product must feel valuable and educational first, transactional second.

c) **Trust-Based Monetization**

(1) Design natural pathways where buyers willingly purchase SCORE Reports because they clearly understand the value, while simultaneously creating compelling reasons for broader registration that don't feel manipulative or overly promotional. The experience must reinforce Pearl's authority and trustworthiness.

2. **Business Model Validation**

a) **Consumer Registration**

(1) Converting visitors to registered users is one of the key proof points we need to establish with this product. This is less important for the ILS portals, but crucial for our investors since conversion is an integral part of our business model and customer/data acquisition strategy, which are all precursors to revenue. Getting on a portal provides cost-effective access to traffic. But if we cannot convert that ILS traffic into registered users, we miss a critical piece of the puzzle. Onboarding both homebuyers and owners now sets the foundation for subsequent product releases that will serve the complete homeowner lifecycle (Own, Improve, Sell phases).

b) **Revenue Stream Diversification**

(1) Prove that consumers will pay for the SCORE Report while demonstrating that registered users provide sustainable pathways beyond contractor subscriptions. MVP 2.0 must validate our ability to monetize direct consumer relationships through valuable performance insights.

c) **Registration-to-Revenue Pipeline**

(1) Establish clear pathways from initial registration to SCORE Report purchases and future product engagement. The platform must demonstrate our ability to convert casual browsers into paying customers and long-term platform participants.

d) **Scaling and Trust Capability**

(1) Show that Pearl's platform can handle consumer-scale traffic and engagement while maintaining the trust and authority necessary for sustained growth. MVP 2.0 must prove our readiness for mass market adoption without compromising our credibility.

F. Success Criteria

How will you know if you accomplished it? Define how the quality of the outcome will/could be measured and determined.

Success for Pearl MVP 2.0 will be measured through specific, quantifiable metrics that demonstrate market acceptance, business model validation, and strategic positioning achievement within the embedded ILS context. These metrics must account for the unique user journey from ILS Snapshot engagement to Pearl platform conversion and SCORE Report purchases.

Note: The following Success Criteria are presented as a straw person—a preliminary, illustrative draft to give the team a sense of the kind of structure and focus we might pursue. These are not

final or prescriptive. Their purpose is to stimulate discussion and serve as a starting point and framework for refinement.

1. **Primary Straw Person Success Metrics**

   a) **ILS Snapshot Engagement and Conversion**

      (1) Snapshot Performance Metrics:

         (a) Snapshot Attention Rate: [X]% of listing viewers stop and engage with the Pearl section

         (b) Snapshot Time Spent: Average [X] seconds spent viewing the Pearl Snapshot within the listing

         (c) Click-Through Rate: [X]% of Snapshot viewers click through to the Pearl site/app for more details

         (d) Snapshot Completion: [X]% of viewers engage with all Snapshot elements (score, pillars, operating costs, achievements)

      (2) Conversion from ILS to Pearl:

         (a) ILS-to-Pearl Traffic: [X] monthly unique visitors referred from ILS partner listings

         (b) Cross-Platform Engagement: [X]% of ILS visitors who click through complete at least one action on the Pearl platform

         (c) Referral Quality: ILS-referred visitors spend [X]% more time on the Pearl platform than direct visitors

   b) **SCORE Report Market Acceptance**

      (1) Purchase Conversion from ILS Context:

         (a) ILS-to-Purchase Rate: [X]% of ILS-referred visitors purchase SCORE Reports

         (b) Purchase Decision Timeline: [X] hours average time from ILS Snapshot view to SCORE Report purchase

         (c) Listing Context Impact: [X]% higher purchase rates for homes with claimed vs. unclaimed Pearl data

      (2) User Engagement with SCORE Reports:

         (a) The percentage who wind up getting the report for homes they have saved and compared.

         (b) Purchase Satisfaction: [X] average rating from post-purchase surveys sent 48-72 hours after delivery

         (c) Repeat Behavior: [X]% of SCORE Report purchasers order bundled reports or additional reports for other properties within 6 months

         (d) Referral Generation: [X]% of purchasers recommend Pearl SCORE Reports to others (measured through follow-up surveys and referral tracking codes)

c) ILS-Related Registrations

(1) Registration Success within ILS Flow:

(a) ILS Registration Rate: [X]% of ILS-referred visitors create Pearl accounts

(b) Registration Context: [X]% of registrations occur during property evaluation vs. general browsing

(c) Claimed Home from ILS: [X]% of ILS-referred registrants complete full home claiming process.

(2) Platform Stickiness:

(a) Return Engagement: [X]% of ILS-referred users return to Pearl within [XX] days

(b) Multi-Property Interest: [X]% of users engage with Pearl data for multiple properties

(c) Pre/Post Contact: What % of buyers who engaged us pre-contract use us once they were under contract?

(d) Feature Adoption: [X]% of ILS-originated users explore additional Pearl features beyond SCORE Reports (including a feature-by-feature breakdown).

(3) Trust and Brand Perception in Real Estate Context:

(a) Net Promoter Score: [X] NPS score from users who discovered Pearl through ILS listings

(b) Listing Agent Feedback: [X]% positive sentiment from agents whose listings include Pearl data

(c) Buyer's Agent Feedback: [X]% positive sentiment from agents who closed on listings that include Pearl data

(d) Buyer Confidence: [X]% of users report increased confidence in home purchase decisions after using Pearl

d) ILS Partnership Value Demonstration

(1) Partner Platform Benefits:

(a) User Engagement Lift: [X]% increase in time spent on listings that include Pearl Snapshots

(b) Listing Differentiation: [X]% of users report Pearl data as a valuable differentiator between properties

(c) Return Traffic: [X]% of Pearl users return to ILS partner platforms for additional property searches

(2) Integration Success Metrics:

(a) Technical Performance: Pearl Snapshot loads within [X] seconds on ILS partner platforms

(i) If they do a bulk data purchase (not an api) and load time is under their control, is this worth measuring? Bearing in mind, from a UX perspective, it doesn't matter who is responsible - the end result is the same.

(b) Cross-Platform Compatibility: Building in a way that maximizes compatibility with different ILS partner technical environments would be desirable. Can we/ should we measure this?

(c) User Experience Seamlessness: [X]% of users rate the ILS-to-Pearl transition as smooth or excellent

(3) Agent Conversion / CTA Metrics

(a) Buyer CTA Conversion Rate:

(i) [%] of users who engage with a Pearl-enhanced listing proceed to a contact form, showing agent interest.

(ii) Rationale: ILSs care about lead generation—if Pearl helps listings generate more leads, it's a win.

(b) Click-through Rate to Agent Profiles:

(i) [%] increase in visits to the agent profile from listings that include Pearl data.

(ii) Rationale: Shows that Pearl boosts visibility for agents, which ILSs monetize.

(c) Agent Satisfaction Score:

(i) [%] of agents rate Pearl's tools as valuable or very valuable in client interactions or listing differentiation.

(ii) Rationale: Builds your case for agent demand and ongoing usage.

(d) Repeat Agent Use:

(i) [%] of agents return to use Pearl for multiple listings (or recommend to peers).

(ii) Rationale: Shows stickiness among your real distribution force—agents.

2. Secondary Straw Person Success Metrics

a) Market Education within Real Estate Context:

(1) Performance Awareness: [X]% increase in user understanding of home performance importance after Snapshot exposure

(2) Decision Influence: [X]% of users report Pearl data influenced their property evaluation

(3) Agent Adoption: [X] % of agents who purchase Pearl SCORE reports for their buyers

b) Competitive Positioning:

(1) Market Share of Attention: Pearl Snapshot engagement rates [X]% higher than other listing enhancement tools

(2) Professional Recognition: [X] mentions of Pearl's ILS integration value

(a) In real estate industry sites and publications with sentiment analysis

(b) In contractor industry sites and publications with sentiment analysis

(c) In consumer social media or publications with sentiment analysis

c) **Operational Excellence in Embedded Context:**

(1) Data Accuracy: [X]% accuracy rate for Pearl Scores displayed in ILS Snapshots

(2) Update Timeliness: Pearl data updates reflected in ILS platforms within [X] hours

(a) Should be monitoring this even if this is up to the ILS?. Makes us look bad (not the ILS) if updates are not timely.

(3) Support Integration: Monitor any issues visitors report when iterating with the Snapshot. If possible, find a way to separate issues caused by the ILS (so we can see how they are doing) from issues originating on our end (so we can see how we are doing). EG:

(a) [X] Pearl-related support issues per ILS and [X]% of Pearl-related inquiries require escalation beyond ILS partner support.

d) **Timeline and Reporting**

(1) Measurement Periods:

(a) Daily: Snapshot engagement and click-through rates

(b) Weekly: ILS-to-Pearl conversion and SCORE Report purchases

(c) Monthly: Registration quality, NPS, and partnership value metrics

(d) Quarterly: Comprehensive success criteria assessment and ILS partner feedback

(2) Success Thresholds: MVP 2.0 is considered successful when at least 80% of primary success metrics meet or exceed targets within 6 months of ILS integration launch, with particular emphasis on demonstrating clear value to both consumers and ILS partners.

(a) Target levels for primary success metrics will evolve over time and depend to some extent on the ILS we are partnered with. For these targets to provide useful guidance, we need to take the ILS partner and the 6-month time frame into account as opposed to absolute targets that ignore context.

(3) Failure Criteria: MVP 2.0 requires strategic reassessment if more than 30% of primary metrics fall below targets after 3 months of ILS integration, if Snapshot engagement rates fall below [X]%, or if ILS partners report significant negative buyer feedback about Pearl integration.

(4) ILS Partner Success Dependency: Success metrics must demonstrate value to ILS partners through increased user engagement, listing differentiation, and positive user feedback to ensure continued and expanded partnership opportunities. Creating new revenue streams or directly supporting existing ones would also help.

3. Pre-launch Testing

a) While these metrics are designed to reflect behavior in a live ILS environment, there have been requests made for data to support our position prior to full ILS integration to help persuade investors and ILS platforms. For these needs, we would develop a study design and select the best methodology depending on what we need to prove or discover.

b) Testing in the registry can be challenging because we don't have the type of traffic that an ILS would typically receive. Where possible and when needed, we could simulate ILS-like traffic and user intent through Pearl's own Registry with targeted paid campaigns, and

strategic referrals to drive the right traffic to the site. These pre-ILS tests may not fully replicate portal dynamics, but could provide some data in advance of a full-scale ILS deployment.

G. Deliverables

List the specific deliverables you are expecting as a result of this project.

This product release will have five main parts:››

1. **Snapshot**
   a) Appears on the ILS and provides a quick and easy way for buyers to assess and compare homes when making their short list, and then understand and evaluate the homes on the list. Comprised of five parts:
      (1) Pearl SCORE
      (2) Claimed/unclaimed status
      (3) Operating cost comparison
      (4) A summary view of the Five Pillars.
      (5) Achievements
   b) Also serves as the introduction to our brand. Must reflect brand values, look, and feel.
   c) The snapshot we design is our best-case proposal of what we want on the ILP portal and how we want it presented. It is likely that they will have their own requirements that may alter what we show and how we show it.
2. **Portrait (working title)**
   a) We are an unknown brand with a new metric. People may be wary of ordering the snapshot on the spot.
   b) We want to keep the Snapshot simple, as in "snapshot". The less we have in the snapshot, the easier it will be for consumers to understand.
   c) But there is context that we feel we need to share, so where do we put it? It's not the type of information that can wait for a report to be issued. It's typically things people would need to know in order for them to trust the score enough to order a report, i.e., things like context, methodology, and light analysis.
   d) We are also trying to find ways to get them into the app.
   e) The promise of finding richer content in the app environment is pretty common. Perhaps we could feed a few birds with one seed if we provide slightly more depth and context to the information provided in the Snapshot, either:
      (1) gated behind registration
      (2) or non-gated, but on our site, where we have a much better chance of earning their trust and enticing them to register.

f) This next layer of info provides useful context and answers a lot of questions that may be raised by the Snapshot, but it certainly is not a full report.

g) Serves as a registration magnet and gateway to buy the SCORE Report for those who need it.

3. SCORE Report

a) Insight to help them understand what it would be like to live in the home. Things like:

(1) Performance-related features (high-performing or not)

(a) defining characteristics / how it works, and what it does

(b) light assessment of efficiency vs today's options

(c) maintenance requirements

(d) probable lifespan

(e) replacement suggestions in case of sudden failure

(2) Performance-related upkeep, maintenance/repair cost

(3) Probable near-term capital investments that will need to be made

(4) Unknowns or potential red flags they will want to look into themselves, or through their agent or inspector

(5) An introduction to the upgrades that Pearl could help them perform if they buy it (light touch, not a full home improvement plan).

b) This would also provide them with input to investigate further with the seller and with their home inspector, as well as some information to use in price negotiations.

c) This is a digital forward living report that resides in the user's account. It will require account setup to access, which will get us closer to the customer and get the customer into our app. Also, it is easy to update as new information about a home is added and to slice and dice data and compare homes in a digital format. The user can export to a static PDF on demand.

4. Desktop/Mobile Consumer App

a) This is all the consumer content, tools, and functionality found behind the registration gate.

b) Most notably, it must

(1) Provide clear value to buyers

(a) E.G., a buyers section with things like:

(i) Home performance basics

(ii) Order reports

(iii) Save homes/lists

(2) Provide clear value to homeowners

(a) E.G., an Owner Section with things like:

(i) Home performance basics

(ii) Add info/improve their score

(iii) Certify their home

(iv) Order reports

5. **Desktop/Mobile Pearl PRO App**

a) This is all the consumer content, tools, and functionality found behind the registration gate.

b) Plus tools for real estate agents, contractors, (inspectors perhaps).

c) Most notably, the ability to

(1) Enter information on behalf of the homeowner

(2) Allow the listing agent to pay for SCORE reports for buyers

(a) Allow buying agents to purchase them for their buyers

H. Activities/Phases

List the activities required to arrive at each of the deliverables. If you feel this project should be completed in phases, where one phase is approved before the next is started, then propose how you would like the process to proceed.

Dividing this project into phases would help all parties understand the timeline and track progress, and understand where we are using the same ruler. If we establish clear completion/approval criteria for each phase, then each phase is approved before the next phase begins. This approach ensures strategic alignment, reduces development risk, and allows for course corrections if needed.

If we take this approach, it may help to specify the following:

A. Duration

B. Purpose

C. Deliverables

D. Who approves

E. Criteria (ambition level) for approval

A suggestion of phases to get us started could be:

- Phase 1: Strategic Briefing Session
- Phase 2: Product Proposal and Pre-Specification
- Phase 3: Detailed Product Specification
- Phase 4: Development Planning and Resource Allocation
- Phase 5: Development and Testing
- Phase 6: Launch and Optimization

I. Timing

Attach a detailed time plan, but here give a broad-stroke overview of the critical deadlines for this project and any issues related to timing you feel the team should be aware of.

1. All timing in this brief is placeholder timing to set some expectation as to project duration.
2. Actual timing will be defined by Product in Phase 2.

J. Risk Mitigation

What factors pose the greatest risk of failure for this project? How have these risks been addressed?

Pearl MVP 2.0 faces several significant risks that could derail our strategic transformation from contractor-centric to a consumer-facing platform. We have identified these risks and developed specific mitigation strategies to address each threat.

1. **Risk 1: Product Development Dysfunction and Fragmentation**
   a) Risk: Initiating numerous uncoordinated product initiatives without strategic focus, leading to a fragmented MVP that doesn't deliver coherent consumer value.
   b) Mitigation:
      (1) Structured Phase Approach: The 6-phase development process with clear approval gates prevents scope creep and ensures strategic alignment and focus
      (2) 3-Day Off-Site Briefing: Dedicated time for complete team alignment before any development begins
      (3) Single Product Focus: MVP 2.0 centers exclusively on the SCORE Report and ILS integration, avoiding feature proliferation
      (4) Vision-Led Development: This brief serves as the decision-making filter for all feature prioritization
2. **Risk 2: Legacy Contractor-Centric Mindset Blocking Consumer Focus**
   a) Risk: Internal teams defaulting to contractor-focused features and technical constraints rather than buyer-centric value creation, resulting in a product that doesn't resonate with consumers.
   b) Mitigation:
      (1) Consumer-First Success Metrics: All primary success criteria measure buyer engagement and satisfaction, not contractor metrics
      (2) User Experience Priority: Phase 2 focuses on buyer journey mapping and user experience design before technical specifications
      (3) ILS Context Design: Designing within the embedded ILS context forces consumer-facing thinking from the start
      (4) Regular User Testing: Built-in user acceptance testing with target buyer personas throughout development

3. **Risk 3: Trust Erosion Through Sales-Centric Approach**
   a) Risk: Creating the perception of Pearl as overly commercial or as unscrupulous data mongers. This would undermine our authority and credibility with both consumers and ILS partners.
   b) Mitigation:
      (1) Leverage About Us: Emphasize our B-Corp status and ethical data policy.
      (2) Innovate with our Data Policy: Strive to include newsworthy aspects in our data policy that get press coverage.
      (3) Trust-Based Monetization Strategy: Product design prioritizes educational value and buyer empowerment over aggressive conversion
      (4) Brand Perception Monitoring: NPS and sentiment tracking specifically measure trust and brand perception
      (5) Educational-First Content: SCORE Reports positioned as objective, informative tools rather than sales instruments
      (6) Natural Conversion Pathways: User flows designed to feel helpful and informative, not manipulative
4. **Risk 4: ILS Partnership Rejection or Delay**
   a) Risk: Major listing platforms declining integration or delaying partnerships, eliminating our primary distribution strategy and market entry path.
   b) Mitigation:
      (1) Dual Value Proposition: Product demonstrates clear value to both buyers AND ILS platforms through increased engagement
      (2) Partnership Development During Development: Phase 5 includes concurrent partnership negotiations and pilot agreements
      (3) Performance Proof Points: Success metrics specifically track ILS partner value (engagement lift, listing differentiation)
      (4) Early Prototype Demonstrations: Working prototypes available by the end of Phase 3 enable the business development team to show functional demos to ILS partners during specification development, providing an 8-12 week head start on partnership discussions
5. **Risk 5: Consumer Market Disinterest in Home Performance**
   a) Risk: Buyers showing insufficient interest in performance data, failing to create the market demand necessary for broader adoption.
   b) Mitigation:
      (1) Performance Translation: Complex building science translated into clear comfort, safety, and cost benefits that buyers care about
      (2) Real Estate Context Integration: Performance information delivered at the moment of highest buyer interest (property evaluation)

(3) Operating Cost Focus: Emphasis on financial benefits (operating costs, savings) that resonate with all buyer segments

(4) Iterative Optimization: Rapid feedback loops and optimization based on actual user engagement data

6. **Risk 6: Technical Scalability and Platform Performance Issues**
   a) Risk: Platform unable to handle consumer-scale traffic, ILS integration demands, or other scaling issues, creating a poor user experience and partnership problems.
   b) Mitigation:
      (1) Scalability Testing Built-In: Load testing for expected traffic volumes is included in Phase 5 quality assurance
      (2) Staged Launch Approach: Soft launch with pilot partners before full-scale deployment
      (3) Performance Monitoring: Real-time tracking of platform performance, load times, and user experience
      (4) Technical Architecture Review: Early assessment of technical requirements and infrastructure needs in Phase 3
7. **Risk 7: Market Timing and Competitive Response**
   a) Risk: Competitors entering the consumer-facing home performance space or market conditions changing before MVP 2.0 launch.
   b) Mitigation:
      (1) Rapid prototyping so we have something to show potential ILS portals and other business partners sooner.
      (2) First-Mover Advantage Protection: Rapid ILS partnership development creates barriers for competitor entry.
      (3) Flexible Market Positioning: Product design allows for positioning adjustments based on market response
      (4) Strategic Partnership Moats: Early ILS integrations create exclusive relationships that are difficult for competitors to replicate
8. **Risk 8: Revenue Model Validation Failure**
   a) Risk: Consumers are unwilling to pay for SCORE Reports.
   b) Mitigation:
      (1) Differentiate the Homes: A major component of this risk is that there isn't enough differentiation between homes to make the report interesting (or to make multiple reports interesting)
      (2) Middle ground: Provide a touch point between looking at the snapshot and buying the report. Allowing users to dig a little deeper on our site/app before pulling the trigger.
      (3) Don’t put all our eggs in one basket: Find valid ways to get them to register. That way, even if they don’t buy a SCORE Report, we still have them in our funnel.

(4) Value-First Approach: Clear demonstration of SCORE Report value before purchase request

(5) Price Testing Capability: Platform designed to support pricing experimentation and optimization

9. **Risk 9: Internal Resource Constraints and Competing Priorities**
   a) Risk: Insufficient development, marketing, or operational resources to execute MVP 2.0 successfully while maintaining existing business operations.
   b) Mitigation:
      (1) Resource Assessment: Once the product spec is approved, ensure Darren engages in a thorough resource requirement evaluation as a reality check.
      (2) Cross-Functional Alignment: All departments involved in planning and committed to success
      (3) Success Metrics Tracking: Early identification of resource gaps through performance monitoring

10. **Comprehensive Risk Management Approach**
   a) Regular Risk Assessment: Monthly risk reviews throughout development phases with mitigation strategy updates
   b) Early Warning Systems: Success metrics designed to identify risk materialization before project failure
   c) Contingency Planning: Each phase includes alternative approaches if primary strategies encounter obstacles
   d) Stakeholder Communication: Transparent risk communication ensures leadership awareness and support for mitigation efforts

K. Team/Reporting

Now that we know what needs to be done, please specify here who the players are and what their responsibilities are. Include any special reporting procedures you would like people to follow.

1. **SPONSOR: Cynthia**
   a) Instigate the project and approve all work
2. **STRATEGIC PLANNER: Sean**
   a) Develops the brief, ensures proposed solutions are on-strategy and on-brand
3. **PROJECT LEADER: Darren**
   a) Opens the project in Monday, works out milestone deadlines with Product and Marketing, monitors progress, and ensures deadlines are met.

4. **PROJECT MANAGER PRODUCT: Rachel**
   a) Defines and assigns work packets to her team, works out deadlines for Product, monitors progress, and ensures deadlines are met.
5. **PROJECT COORDINATOR MARKETING: Grant**
   a) Defines and assigns work packets to his team, works out deadlines for Marketing, monitors progress, and ensures deadlines are met.
6. **PROJECT SME CONTRIBUTORS:**
   a) RACHEL: Product
   b) AC: Development
   c) ROBIN: Corporate strategy and building science
   d) CASEY - CX
   e) JEFF: Engineering
   f) SEAN: Marketing
   g) TIM: Business Development
   h) SANDY -Corporate Strategy

L. Guidelines or Suggestions

Any mandatories, tips, or requests?

1. **Short-Form Brief**
   a) Given the importance and breadth of this project, this brief is rather long. We have gone into some detail to explain the thinking behind some of the decisions. This should help with the leadership session in C'Ville, but may be TMI for a general audience.
   b) Once we have buy-off on the long-form brief, a shorter version can be created for general distribution.

M. Attachments

Any documents attached related to this assignment

1. **Appendix 1: Home Buyer Journey Timeline**
2. **Appendix 2: Target Market and Positioning**

II. Appendix 1: Home Buyer Journey Timeline

No two homebuyer journeys are the same, and those journeys change based on geography, market conditions, and buyer type. Understanding that, we still wanted to create a model journey to use as a reference.

This is a mostly AI-generated list. It is intended to be a comprehensive starting point that we can refine with SME input moving forward.

We present it because it provides input for possible product development moving forward. Behind each of these steps, we can discover consumer needs. Some are strong, others weak; some we can address, others we cannot. We wanted to catalog them here as a resource.

A. Phase 1: Preparation (1-3 months)

1. Financial Preparation

a) Check credit score and address any issues
b) Create a budget and determine the price range
c) Gather financial documents (tax returns, bank statements, pay stubs)
d) Research mortgage types and lenders
e) Apply for mortgage pre-approval with 2-3 lenders
f) Compare pre-approval offers and select a lender
g) Receive a pre-approval letter (valid for 60-90 days typically)

2. Need/Want Assessment

a) Create a list of non-negotiable home features
b) Create a wishlist of desired but not required features
c) Determine the minimum square footage needed
d) Decide on preferred home types (single-family, townhouse, condo)
e) Establish priorities (e.g., location vs. size vs. condition)

3. Location Research

a) Research potential neighborhoods or towns
b) Check school district ratings if applicable
c) Calculate commute times to work/school
d) Research property tax rates by location
e) Visit neighborhoods at different times of day

f) Check crime statistics for potential areas
g) Research amenities and services (grocery stores, parks, etc.)

4. Finding a Realtor

a) Ask friends, family, and colleagues for referrals
b) Research realtors online (Zillow, Realtor.com, social media)
c) Read online reviews and testimonials
d) Check licensing status with the state Real Estate Commission
e) Create a shortlist of 3-5 potential realtors
f) Prepare questions for interviewing realtors
g) Interview each realtor regarding:
   (1) Experience with first-time buyers
   (2) Knowledge of target neighborhoods
   (3) Typical communication style and frequency
   (4) Availability (evenings, weekends)
   (5) Experience with your price range
   (6) References from recent clients
   (7) Commission structure and buyer's agreement terms
h) Check references from past clients
i) Select a realtor and review the buyer's agent agreement
j) Sign buyer's agent agreement (usually 3-6 months)

B. Phase 2: Active Search (2-3 months)

1. Initial Search Setup

a) Set up saved searches on real estate platforms (Zillow, Redfin, Realtor.com)
b) Create email alerts for new listings matching the criteria
c) Discuss search criteria in detail with the realtor
d) Have the realtor set up MLS search alerts
e) Download real estate apps for mobile searching
f) Create a system for tracking and rating potential homes

2. Regular Property Monitoring

a) Check new listings daily
b) Review listing photos for each potential property
c) Evaluate property details against a must-have list

d) Research property history (time on market, price changes)
e) Check property tax history
f) Look up flood zones and other environmental factors
g) Research the HOA details if applicable
h) Create an initial list of 15-20 potential properties

3. Virtual Property Review

a) Take virtual tours when available
b) Use Google Street View to explore neighborhoods
c) Check satellite images of properties and surroundings
d) Conduct drive-bys of properties at different times
e) Research nearby amenities using mapping tools
f) Check walkability and transit scores
g) Analyze comparable sales in the neighborhood
h) Refine the list to 8-10 properties for in-person visits

C. Phase 3: In-Person Investigation (1-2 months)

1. Open House Visits

a) Create a schedule of upcoming open houses
b) Prepare questions for each property
c) Bring a notebook and a camera/phone for documentation
d) Wear comfortable shoes for a thorough exploration
e) Arrive early for a less crowded viewing
f) Take notes on each property during the visit
g) Ask listing agent-specific property questions:
   (1) Age of major systems (roof, HVAC, water heater)
   (2) Known issues with the property
   (3) Recent renovations or repairs
   (4) Seller's timeline and motivation
   (5) Property history and previous owners
   (6) Utility costs
h) Document important features with photos
i) Note initial impressions immediately after leaving

2. **Private Showings**
   a) Coordinate with a realtor for scheduling
   b) Group showings geographically, when possible
   c) Allow 30-45 minutes per property
   d) Bring a checklist of features to evaluate
   e) Check all major systems visually:
      (1) Test all faucets and flush toilets
      (2) Turn on/off lights and check outlets
      (3) Open/close windows and doors
      (4) Check for signs of water damage
      (5) Inspect the basement or crawlspace if accessible
      (6) Check attic access if possible
   f) Measure rooms if dimensions are important
   g) Test cell phone reception throughout the house
   h) Note noise levels from outside and between rooms
   i) Discuss observations with the realtor during and after a visit
3. **Detailed Property Comparison**
   a) Create a comparison spreadsheet of top properties
   b) Rate each property on key criteria
   c) Calculate potential monthly payments for each
   d) Research neighborhood trends for each location
   e) Check the permit history for previous work done
   f) Research school assignments, if applicable
   g) Identify any red flags requiring further investigation
   h) Narrow the list to 3-5 top contenders
4. **Second Viewings**
   a) Schedule second visits to top contenders
   b) Visit at different times of day from the first viewing
   c) Bring family members or trusted friends for opinions
   d) Focus on specific concerns noted during the first visit
   e) Check specific measurements for furniture placement
   f) Test commute from the property during rush hour
   g) Visit local amenities (parks, shops, restaurants)

h) Take more detailed photos and notes

i) Finalize ranking of top properties

D. Phase 4: Decision & Offer (2 weeks)

1. Final Property Selection

a) Conduct a final assessment of the top 2-3 properties

b) Research comparable sales for each finalist

c) Discuss pros/cons with realtor and trusted advisors

d) Drive neighborhoods at night for safety assessment

e) Check with the lender to confirm financing specifics

f) Review the HOA documents if applicable

g) Make the final selection

2. Offer Preparation

a) Research recent comparable sales with a realtor

b) Determine the initial offer price strategy

c) Discuss contingencies to include:

(1) Inspection contingency (typically 7-10 days)

(2) Financing contingency (typically 30-45 days)

(3) Appraisal contingency

(4) Title contingency

(5) Sale of current home contingency (if applicable)

d) Determine earnest money amount (typically 1-2% of the offer)

e) Decide on the proposed closing timeline

f) Specify any personal property to be included

g) Discuss the escalation clause if in a competitive market

h) Review the seller's disclosure form if available

3. Offer Submission

a) Sign the offer documents prepared by the realtor

b) Submit an earnest money check

c) Include a pre-approval letter with an offer

d) Write a personal letter to the seller (optional)

e) Determine offer expiration timeframe (24-48 hours typically)

f) Submit the complete offer package through a realtor

g) Confirm receipt of the offer by the listing agent

4. Negotiation Process

a) Wait for the seller's response
b) Review any counteroffers
c) Discuss the response strategy with the realtor
d) Submit a counteroffer if needed
e) Continue negotiation until an agreement is reached or abandoned
f) Sign the final accepted offer documents
g) Submit increased earnest money if required
h) Begin formal escrow period

E. Phase 5: Home Inspection (2 weeks)

1. Home Inspector Selection

a) Request inspector recommendations from a realtor
b) Research inspectors independently online
c) Verify credentials (ASHI, InterNACHI certification)
d) Check licensing if required in your state
e) Read online reviews from previous clients
f) Call 2-3 inspectors to interview:
   (1) Years of experience
   (2) Areas of specialization
   (3) Cost and what's included
   (4) Report delivery timeline
   (5) Sample report availability
   (6) Insurance coverage
g) Request and review sample inspection reports
h) Compare fees and services (typically $300-$700)
i) Select an inspector and schedule an appointment

2. Inspection Process

a) Schedule inspection within the contingency period (7-10 days after accepted offer)
b) Confirm seller approval of inspection date/time
c) Plan to attend the entire inspection (2-4 hours)
d) Arrive with a notebook, camera, and measuring tape

e) Walk through the property with the inspector
f) Ask questions throughout the process
g) Take photos of any issues identified
h) Request explanations of systems and maintenance requirements
i) Take notes on the inspector's verbal findings
j) Discuss major concerns at the conclusion of the inspection

3. Specialized Inspections (as needed)

a) Based on general inspection findings, schedule specialized inspections:
   (1) Radon testing (24-48 hours)
   (2) Mold inspection
   (3) Pest/termite inspection
   (4) Sewer line scope
   (5) Lead paint testing (pre-1978 homes)
   (6) Asbestos testing (older homes)
   (7) Structural engineer assessment
b) Coordinate access for each specialized inspector
c) Review the results of each specialized inspection

4. Inspection Response

a) Receive and review detailed inspection report (typically 24-48 hours after inspection)
b) Discuss findings with the realtor
c) Categorize issues by severity:
   (1) Safety hazards
   (2) Major defects
   (3) Minor defects
   (4) Maintenance items
d) Get repair cost estimates for major items
e) Determine response strategy:
   (1) Request repairs from the seller
   (2) Request credit at closing
   (3) Request a price reduction
   (4) Accept property as-is
   (5) Walk away from the purchase
f) Draft a formal inspection response with the realtor

g) Submit a response to the seller with supporting documentation
h) Negotiate the final resolution of inspection items
i) Sign the inspection resolution document
j) Remove inspection contingency once satisfied

F. Phase 6: Closing Process (30-45 days)

1. Mortgage Application Process

a) Submit a formal loan application
b) Pay the application fee if required
c) Provide all requested documentation:
   (1) Recent pay stubs
   (2) W-2s and tax returns
   (3) Bank statements
   (4) Investment account statements
   (5) Explanation of any large deposits
   (6) Gift letters if using gift funds
d) Respond promptly to lender requests for additional information
e) Avoid new credit applications or large purchases
f) Maintain employment status
g) Keep detailed records of all communications

2. Home Appraisal

a) Lender orders appraisal
b) Pay appraisal fee (typically $300-$600)
c) Confirm appraisal appointment date
d) Ensure the property is accessible for the appraiser
e) Receive appraisal results
f) If the appraisal comes in low:
   (1) Negotiate a price reduction with the seller
   (2) Pay the difference out of pocket
   (3) Request appraisal review
   (4) Walk away (using appraisal contingency)

3. Title Search and Insurance

a) Lender orders title search

b) Review the preliminary title report
c) Address any title issues or liens discovered
d) Shop for title insurance (if allowed in your state)
e) Review the title insurance coverage options
f) Pay for title insurance

4. **Homeowners Insurance**
   a) Research insurance companies and request quotes
   b) Compare coverage options and premiums
   c) Select an insurance provider
   d) Pay for the first year of coverage
   e) Provide proof of insurance to the lender

5. **Final Mortgage Approval**
   a) Receive a loan commitment letter
   b) Review loan terms and conditions
   c) Clear any conditional approval items
   d) Schedule closing date and time
   e) Receive Closing Disclosure (at least three business days before closing)
   f) Review the Closing Disclosure for accuracy
   g) Compare to the Loan Estimate for significant changes
   h) Resolve any discrepancies with a lender

6. **Pre-Closing Steps**
   a) Schedule final walk-through (24 hours before closing)
   b) Conduct a thorough walk-through:
      (1) Verify all agreed-upon repairs completed
      (2) Ensure the property condition has remained unchanged since the inspection
      (3) Check that all included items remain
      (4) Test all systems and appliances
      (5) Check that the seller's items have been removed
   c) Address any issues discovered during the walk-through
   d) Get certified funds for closing costs (cashier's check or wire transfer)
   e) Gather identification and all required documents
   f) Confirm closing location and time

7. Closing Day

a) Bring to closing:
   (1) Government-issued photo ID
   (2) Cashier's check or wire transfer confirmation
   (3) Copy of Closing Disclosure
   (4) Homeowners insurance proof
   (5) Any remaining required documents
b) Review and sign all closing documents (typically 50-100 pages)
c) Pay closing costs
d) Receive keys and garage door openers
e) Get copies of all signed documents
f) Record the deed with the county

G. Phase 7: Move-In and Setup (1-2 months)

1. Immediate Post-Purchase Tasks

a) Change locks or rekey all exterior doors
b) Reset garage door opener codes
c) Update address with:
   (1) USPS
   (2) DMV
   (3) Voter registration
   (4) Banks and credit cards
   (5) Insurance providers
   (6) Employers
   (7) Subscription services
d) Transfer utilities to your name:
   (1) Electricity
   (2) Gas
   (3) Water/sewer
   (4) Internet
   (5) Cable/satellite
   (6) Trash collection
e) Test all smoke and carbon monoxide detectors
f) Locate the main water shut-off valve

g) Locate the electrical panel
h) Change HVAC filters

2. **Moving Process**
   a) Determine moving method (DIY vs. professional)
   b) If hiring movers:
      (1) Research moving companies
      (2) Get 3+ written estimates
      (3) Check reviews and credentials
      (4) Verify insurance coverage
      (5) Book movers 4-8 weeks in advance
   c) If DIY:
      (1) Reserve a moving truck
      (2) Gather packing supplies
      (3) Recruit help
      (4) Plan loading strategy
   d) Pack non-essential items first
   e) Create an inventory of valuable items
   f) Pack an essentials box for the first night
   g) Arrange for pet care during the move
   h) Clean the new home before moving in
   i) Supervise movers or coordinate helpers
   j) Verify all items arrived and are undamaged

3. **Initial Home Setup**
   a) Unpack essentials first
   b) Set up bedrooms
   c) Organize kitchen
   d) Install window treatments
   e) Set up a home security system if desired
   f) Establish maintenance routines:
      (1) HVAC filter replacement schedule
      (2) Gutter cleaning
      (3) Chimney inspection
      (4) Smoke detector testing

g) Create a digital or physical home maintenance file
h) Meet neighbors
i) Explore neighborhood amenities

4. **Initial Improvements**
   a) Address any immediate repair needs
   b) Deep clean the entire home
   c) Paint if desired
   d) Replace light fixtures if desired
   e) Install shelf liners in the kitchen
   f) Replace toilet seats
   g) Pest control treatment, if needed
   h) Create a prioritized list of future projects
5. **Develop a budget for home improvements**
6. **Research contractors for planned projects**

III. Appendix 2: Target Market and Positioning

A. Who are We Talking To?

1. Primary Target: The First-Time Home Buyer

a) Meet Sarah, 38, a digital marketing coordinator earning $65K annually, who is buying her first home after saving for a down payment over three years. She's been renting for six years and is excited but overwhelmed by the home-buying process. Sarah spends hours on Zillow, Realtor.com, and Redfin, bookmarking dozens of properties and creating spreadsheets to track details. She's comparing 15-20 properties online and has visited eight homes in person. As a first-time buyer, she's anxious about making the right decision and terrified of costly mistakes since this represents her largest financial commitment ever. Sarah relies heavily on online research, reads reviews obsessively, and seeks validation from friends, family, and professionals. She's budget-conscious, having stretched to afford the down payment, and worried about ongoing costs she might not have considered. Sarah trusts data and third-party verification over sales pitches, having learned to be skeptical of seller claims through her research.

2. Which of Their Needs are We Leveraging?

a) Primary Need: Performance Blind Spot Elimination Sarah can see square footage, photos, and neighborhood data, but has no way to understand how the home will actually perform for her family's comfort levels, safety features, operating costs, or potential maintenance issues. She needs an objective, professional assessment of the home's functional performance to make confident decisions.

b) Secondary Need: Financial Protection and Predictability. Sarah needs to understand the true cost of homeownership beyond the mortgage payment. She wants to predict utility bills, identify potential expensive repairs, and understand which homes will cost more to operate and maintain long-term. This is not her forever home. She is also planning on moving on to a nicer home at some point and wants to know about ROI and be in a good position when that day comes.

c) Facilitation Strategy: We provide the missing performance layer in real estate transactions through the Pearl Snapshot (visible at the moment of property evaluation) and detailed SCORE Report (when she needs a comprehensive analysis). This transforms her property evaluation from guesswork to informed decision-making.

3. What Emotions/Beliefs Should We Address?

a) **Existing Beliefs and Emotions:**

(1) Skepticism of Seller Claims: Sarah assumes sellers hide problems and exaggerate benefits, so she values independent, third-party assessment

(2) Fear of Unknown Costs: She's anxious about discovering expensive issues after purchase and wants to avoid buyer's remorse

(3) Information Overload Fatigue: She's overwhelmed by property details but frustrated by a lack of meaningful performance information

(4) Trust in Professional Standards: She believes in certifications and professional assessments (like home inspections) and expects them to be objective

(5) Technology Expectation: She expects important information to be readily available online and gets frustrated when she has to "dig" for basic details

(6) Value-Conscious Decision Making: She's willing to pay more upfront for better long-term value, but needs clear evidence of that value

b) **Emotional Positioning:**

(1) We must feel authoritative but not intimidating, informative but not overwhelming, and trustworthy but not boring. Sarah should feel empowered and confident, not sold to or manipulated.

4. Who/What are We Competing Against?

a) Primary Competition: Non-Consumption. Most buyers like Sarah simply proceed without performance information, relying on visual inspection, basic home inspection, and hope. This is our biggest competitor - the status quo of buying without performance data.

b) Secondary Competition: Partial Solutions that the target could perceive as a suitable substitute for Pearl.

(1) Other apps for homebuyers/owners

(2) Home Inspections: Identify problems, but don't quantify overall performance or operating costs

(3) Energy Audits: Focus only on energy efficiency, not comprehensive performance

(4) Utility Bill Analysis: Historical data that may not reflect current systems or usage patterns

(5) Real Estate Agent Advice: Often subjective and focused on closing the deal rather than an objective assessment

c) Tertiary Competition: DIY Research Sarah might try to research home performance herself through utility companies, contractors, or online tools, but this is time-consuming, incomplete, and often unreliable.

5. How are We Different?

a) How do we stand out from the crowd defined above? Note: These points of differentiation must be highly interesting to the target and relevant to their needs and value requirements.

b) Unique Differentiators:

(1) Comprehensive Performance Integration: Unlike partial solutions, Pearl Score covers all five pillars (safety, comfort, operations, resilience, energy) in one unified assessment that shows how they interact.

(2) Available at Point of Decision: Unlike inspections or audits that happen after you're committed to a property, Pearl Score is available during your initial property search when you're comparing options.

(3) Objective, Third-Party Authority: Government-endorsed (DOE, EPA) and industry-recognized certification provides credibility that DIY research and agent opinions cannot match.

(4) Operating Cost Transparency: The only solution that translates home performance into predictable monthly operating costs, helping buyers understand the true cost of ownership.

(5) Comparison-Enabled: Pearl Score allows direct performance comparison between properties, something no other solution provides during property search.

(6) Professional Grade, Consumer Friendly: Built on rigorous building science but presented in clear, actionable insights that don't require technical expertise to understand and use.

c) Relevance to Sarah's Values:

(1) Data-driven decision making: Pearl Score provides the missing performance data layer

(2) Financial protection: Operating cost estimates help budget and avoid surprises

(3) Time efficiency: Integrated into her existing property search workflow

(4) Professional credibility: Third-party certification she can trust and defend to family/spouse

CA Segment	Need	Need Context
Buyers	**Compare**	**WHEN**: At the start of their new home search. **WHAT**: Be able to quickly compare home performance online when making a short list. **ASSUMPTION**: This assumes that home performance matters to them.
Buyers	**Understand**	**WHEN**: In the middle of their new home search. **WHAT**: The buyer is eager to learn as much as possible about the homes they are considering. The buyer of any home has this need, not just buyers of high-performance homes. The report should cover all systems (HP and otherwise) with equal vigor. **ASSUMPTION**: Most people don't really understand a home's systems. This assumes that home performance matters to them.
Buyers	**Predict**	**WHEN**: Near the end of their new home search. **WHAT**: To understand the home(s) they will make an offer on. Get a feel for what they are getting into, operating costs, and likely repairs/upgrades required on a specific home on their short list. The buyer of any home has this need, not just buyers of high-performance homes. The report must cover all systems (HP and otherwise) with equal vigor. **ASSUMPTION**: Most people don't really understand a home's systems. This assumes that home performance matters to them.
Buyers - HP Home Seekers	**Compare**	**WHEN**: At the start of their new home search. **WHAT**: Be able to quickly identify HP homes and compare home performance online when making a short list. **ASSUMPTION**: This assumes that home performance matters to them.
Buyers - HP Home Seekers	**Understand**	**WHEN**: In the middle of their new home search. **WHAT**: The buyer of any home is eager to learn as much as possible about the homes they are considering. But with HP containing fewer traditional systems, the need is even more acute. **ASSUMPTION**: Most people don't really understand a home's systems. This assumes that home performance matters to them.